

TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Employee IT, Security & Workplace Policy Handbook

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Section 1: Introduction & Scope

This handbook applies to all full-time, part-time, and contract employees of TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd. across all office locations, including employees working remotely. It consolidates the company's policies on information security, device usage, leave, reimbursement, and workplace conduct. All employees are required to acknowledge this handbook within 7 days of joining.

The Human Resources department reviews this document annually every December, and any policy changes take effect on 1 January of the following year. Employees are notified of material changes at least 15 days in advance via the internal HR portal.

Section 2: Password & Account Security Policy

All employee accounts must use a password of at least 12 characters, containing a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and at least one special character. Passwords must be changed every 90 days and cannot repeat any of the last 5 previously used passwords.

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all accounts that access company email, the HR portal, or any cloud storage system. Employees who disable MFA without written approval from IT Security will have their account access suspended within 24 hours of detection.

Shared accounts are strictly prohibited except for designated service accounts approved by the IT Security team. Any suspected compromise of login credentials must be reported immediately using the procedure in Section 6.

Section 3: Data Classification & Handling

Company data is classified into three tiers: Public, Internal, and Restricted. Restricted data includes customer personal information, financial records, and unreleased product designs, and may only be stored on company-approved encrypted drives or the corporate cloud storage platform.

Employees are prohibited from transferring Restricted data to personal email accounts, personal cloud storage, or removable USB drives. Any exception requires written sign-off from both the employee's manager and the Data Protection Officer.

All Restricted data must be encrypted at rest using AES-256 encryption and in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher. Data retention for Restricted records is 7 years from the date of creation, after which records must be securely deleted per the disposal checklist maintained by IT Security.

Section 4: Remote Work & VPN Policy

Employees working remotely must connect to company systems exclusively through the corporate VPN. Split tunneling is disabled by default on all VPN profiles to ensure all traffic is routed through company security monitoring.

Remote employees are required to work from a secured, private internet connection. Use of public Wi-Fi (cafes, airports, co-working spaces) for accessing Restricted data is not permitted under any circumstance, even with VPN enabled.

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week without prior manager approval. Fully remote arrangements beyond 3 days per week require a signed Remote Work Agreement, renewed every 6 months.

Section 5: Device & Equipment Policy

Company laptops are replaced on a 3-year refresh cycle from the date of issue. Employees may request an early replacement only in case of hardware failure verified by the IT Helpdesk.

All company laptops are pre-installed with endpoint detection software, disk encryption, and remote wipe capability. Employees must not disable, uninstall, or tamper with any of these tools.

Personal devices (BYOD) may be used to access company email only, and only after enrolling the device in the Mobile Device Management (MDM) system. BYOD devices are not permitted to access the internal engineering codebase or Restricted data systems.

Section 6: Security Incident Reporting Procedure

Any suspected security incident — including phishing emails, lost devices, or unauthorized account access — must be reported to security@technova.example within 4 hours of discovery.

Upon receiving a report, the IT Security team acknowledges it within 1 hour during business hours and begins triage. Critical incidents (confirmed data breach or ransomware) trigger the Incident Response Plan and must be escalated to the CTO within 2 hours of confirmation.

Employees who fail to report a known security incident within the required window may be subject to disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct outlined in Section 9.

Section 7: Leave & Attendance Policy

Full-time employees are entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave and 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Unused annual leave, up to a maximum of 10 days, may be carried forward to the next calendar year; any balance beyond that is forfeited.

Leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 3 working days in advance, except for sick leave, which may be reported on the day of absence with a follow-up note submitted within 48 hours.

Employees are expected to log attendance via the HR portal by 10:30 AM on working days. Three or more unexplained late log-ins in a month trigger an automated notification to the employee's reporting manager.

Section 8: Expense Reimbursement Policy

All business expense claims must be submitted through the Finance portal within 30 days of the expense being incurred. Claims submitted after 30 days require written approval from the employee's department head to be processed.

Receipts are mandatory for all claims above 1,500 INR. For expenses of 1,500 INR or below, a self-declaration is sufficient, up to a maximum of 5,000 INR in undocumented claims per quarter.

Approved reimbursements are processed in the next payroll cycle, which runs on the 7th of every month. Travel expenses follow a separate policy documented in the Travel & Mobility Handbook.

Section 9: Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism at all times. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Conflicts of interest, including outside employment or financial interests in competitor organizations, must be disclosed to HR in writing before accepting any such engagement.

Violations of this Code of Conduct are reviewed by a panel consisting of an HR representative, the employee's department head, and a member of the Legal team. Findings are communicated to the employee within 10 working days of the review being initiated.

Section 10: Escalation & Contact Matrix

The table below lists the primary contact points for common employee queries.

Topic	Contact	Response SLA
IT Security Incidents	security@technova.example	1 hour (business hours)
Payroll & Reimbursement	finance@technova.example	3 working days
Leave & HR Queries	hr@technova.example	2 working days
Code of Conduct Concerns	ethics@technova.example	5 working days
Device / Laptop Issues	helpdesk@technova.example	4 business hours

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